



No more bloatware?

Practise of pre installing apps from the device maker will be changed under a proposed law. <https://digit.in/jul21-85>



OnePlus restricts popular apps

OnePlus intentionally lowers performance in several popular apps to enhance battery life. <https://digit.in/jul21-86>

rus that was popular among the Egyptians. The main advantage that the Roman codices had over their Egyptian scroll counterparts was that they were much easier to store and transport, and thus gained a lot more popularity. But scrolls did not lose out their relevance completely as many Princely States and Monarchies still communicated many of their messages formally, with scrolls.

One of the first popular texts that was documented in the Roman codices was the Bible, as it became as staple for the missionaries, priests and preachers who wanted to carry their holy book around without the hassle that came with using scrolls. Things



The Codex Gigas, 13th century, Bohemia.

continued to evolve in the field of books as groups across the world came up with their own techniques to improve this new way of documentation that was helping not only in preserving history and their cultures but also spreading awareness and information amongst people.

We must all be aware of the fact that Johannes Gutenberg was the one who invented the first printing press in 1439 CE, and thus began an era of printed books as we see them today. But, printing technology had been around for a long long time before that, they were simply not as mainstream as they became after the invention of the printing press. In fact, the first book as it is claimed by researchers and scholars all around the world was a Chinese publication called the Diamond Sutra.

Once the printing press had been invented though, printing technol-



A page from the Diamond Sutra

ogy changed forever. It was after the development of the Gutenberg press, as it is popularly called, that in the year 1582 CE we saw the first dictionary of the world being published by a gentleman called Richard Mulcaster. Called the 'Elementarie' by Mulcaster, it contained as many as 8000 words in a list that wasn't even alphabetical. Imagine hunting for the meaning of a newly found word in that monstrosity. But, when compared to its modern counterpart, the popular Oxford Dictionary, it was literally a fraction of the book. As it stands today, the Oxford dictionary contains more than 2,73,000 words within it, which makes Mulcaster's 'Elementarie' a mere 1/34th of the Oxford dictionary.

Then came the era of the Penny Dreadfuls in America and Britain as book publishing became more and more a part of the mainstream. The Penny Dreadfuls earned their name because they were simple rewrites of older gothic horror stories and could be bought for just a penny. Once the books were accepted by society, publishers started working towards catering to what the demands of the market were back then.

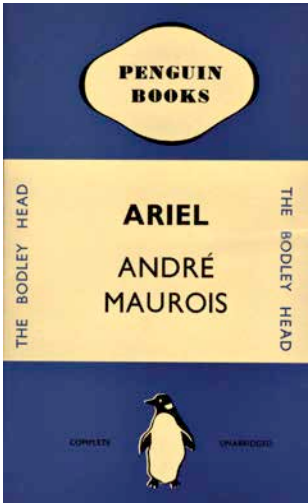
Around the 19th century, the world saw the publication of the first hard cover books, which in their truest sense were just a novelty item for the rich, at the time, that would be bought by them to boast about how well read they were. One of the first paper backs, the relatively cheaper and widely accessible form of books, that was

ever published was by one of the most recognised publishers of the modern world, Penguin Books, way back in 1935 and could be bought for an amount as low as six pence.

The modern revolution in the world of printing that came after that time was interesting and if followed closely can connect the dots to many mysteries and fables that are considered to be unfathomable by a normal human being. Books have been used all over the world for all

intents and purposes. Literally. They could contain peace promoting religious teachings, dictator pleasing propaganda or sensual stories that one might hide away in a corner to read. Such is their power. They have changed shapes over the years and have landed into their current greatest and latest form, which is eBooks, which are digital renditions of the traditional books that can be stored in digital devices and

can be read anywhere, anytime. But, no matter how much the Kindles and other eReaders of the world try to emulate the feel of books, there is one thing that they will not be able to replace. That is the smell of a fresh book. 



One of the first books ever published by Penguin